

SOUNDMUD

NORTH STAR

VISION STATEMENT

Soundmud exists to close the gap between where founders are and where they want to be - not by looking up at those who've already made it, but by learning from those just one or two steps ahead.

It's a platform for the honest, practical conversations that most founder content skips: the workstreams, the automation, the AI decisions, the unglamorous stuff that actually makes a business work.

***In a year:** 1,000 subscribers who feel like they're building alongside someone who gets it.*

WHAT BUILDING WELL MEANS FOR SOUNDMUD

Sustainability for Soundmud isn't an add-on - it's a design principle. Building something that gives back as much as it takes: knowledge that circulates rather than sits still, spaces and materials used thoughtfully, and a platform where every part feeds back.

***The principle:** doing good for himself, his listeners, and the world Soundmud operates in - not as an afterthought, but as part of how it's built from the start.*

3 STRATEGIC COMMITMENTS: NEXT 12 MONTHS

1. Build sustainability in from the start, visibly

Competitors aren't doing this. That's the opportunity. Sustainability becomes a differentiator - something listeners can see, reference, and share. Not performance, but proof: a tree planting scheme, CO2 transparency, conscious partnerships.

2. Design for circularity

Knowledge doesn't have to be one-directional. Soundmud can model what it talks about - repeat guests who build on previous conversations, listener voices feeding back into content, spaces and materials used with intention. Circular by design, not by accident.

3. Grow with purpose, not just speed

Competitors 10 steps ahead isn't the benchmark. The benchmark is whether the right listeners - UK-based founders and aspiring founders - are finding genuine value in the podcast. Sponsorship and growth strategy should reflect that: local partners, sustainability-aligned brands, audiences that matter more than numbers that look good.

DECISION FILTER

Before committing to anything - a guest, a format, a partner, a tool - ask:

"Does this move Soundmud forward, and does it leave something better than I found it?"

Forward = closer to the founder community you're building for and true to why you're doing this

Better = circular, intentional,



ACTION PLAN

30-DAY PRIORITIES - SEQUENCED

#	Action + Why It Matters	Timeframe	Breakdown
1	Set a 1-year goal for Soundmud and build a backwards plan from it <i>Everything else becomes clearer once there's a destination. This was missing before this conversation.</i>	30 days (runs through the month alongside the other actions)	Pod structure, bulk recordings, editing schedule, back-up guests, filming windows, etc - move with consistency.
2	Audit current and planned spaces/materials for circular use <i>Small decisions made early are easier than reversals later. Flag anything you'd want to change.</i>	7 days (tackle this first in the 30-day priority list)	Collate list of locations in/around London (outside & inside) e.g. cafes, museums, libraries, etc.
3	Map 2-3 indirect sustainability impacts that could become USPs <i>This is where Soundmud starts to look different from every other founder podcast.</i>	5 days (at the start of the month)	Streamline what we've deemed are indirect impacts & finalise their integration in the POC/website.
4	Research tree planting schemes - find one that's credible and visible <i>First sustainability proof point. Low friction, high signal. Unlocks the website sustainability page.</i>	7 days (tackle this in the 2nd week of the 30 days)	Nation- or county-dependent? Look at examples that already work well.
5	Scope the AI carbon calculator concept for the website <i>Your idea, your energy behind it. Move it from concept to a rough spec - even a paragraph of what it does is progress.</i>	21 days (first 3 weeks of the 30 days)	Set-up a website, build out with AI and create the first calculator iteration.

SHARED LANGUAGE

Audience	What They Care About	Your Language
Investors	Scale + defensibility	Sustainability isn't nice-to-have - it's our competitive advantage. Competitors 10 steps ahead aren't the threat. We're building for the UK founder who wants authentic, practical knowledge. That's a moat.
Hires	Purpose + craft	We're modelling circularity in everything we do. Knowledge flows both ways. You're not just producing a podcast - you're building a system that gets better because of how we structure it.
Listeners	Authenticity + utility	Real conversations with people one or two steps ahead. No glamour, just the actual workstreams, decisions, and trade-offs that build a business.

